

FACUNDO URRETA BENITEZ

Sleep and Memory Laboratory

<https://www.labsuenoymemoria.com/>

Instituto Tecnológico de Buenos Aires | Iguazú 341 (1437), Capital Federal, Argentina

Email: furreta@itba.edu.ar

CURRENT POSITIONS

- **CONICET / Innocence Project Doctoral Fellow.** Member of the Sleep and Memory Lab, Dept. of Life Sciences, ITBA.
- **PhD Candidate.** Universidad Nacional del Centro de la Provincia de Buenos Aires. CONSTRUCTION OF FALSE MEMORIES IN WITNESSES OF AN EVENT: THE ROLE OF CONSOLIDATION, RECONSOLIDATION, AND SLEEP STAGES. Supervisors: Dr. Cecilia Forcato, Dr. Cristian Bauza.

PREVIOUS POSITIONS

- **ITBA Teaching Assistant,** JTP for the course Neurosciences and Productive Development. Dept. of Life Sciences, ITBA. 2022-2025
- **UBA Teaching Assistant,** ATP 1° ad honorem, for the course General Psychology, Faculty of Psychology, University of Buenos Aires. Buenos Aires, Argentina. 2022-2024

ACADEMIC DEGREES

- **Bachelor's Degree in Psychology.** Faculty of Psychology, University of Buenos Aires. Buenos Aires, Argentina.
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LANGUAGES

- **English.** Advanced
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POSTGRADUATE COURSES

- **Diploma in Applied Basic Biostatistics with R** — 2020
 - **Neurobiology of Learning and Memory** — 2021
 - **Programming in Python** — 2021
 - **Neuroanatomy and Cellular & Structural Neurobiology** — 2023
 - **Methodology for the Study of Social Perception on Environmental and Health Issues** — 2024
 - **Artificial Intelligence** — 2024
 - **Concepts and Tools for Thesis Design** — 2024
 - **Technological Surveillance and Strategic Intelligence (Data Science)** — 2024
 - **Biomedical Signal Processing** — 2025
 - **English Language** — 2025
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ARTICLES PUBLISHED IN INTERNATIONAL JOURNALS

Leon, C. S., Celso, A. L. L., **Benítez, F. A. U.**, Bonilla, M., Olivar, N., Toledo, J., ... & Forcato, C. (2024). Differential effects of clonazepam on declarative memory formation and face recognition. *Neurobiology of Learning and Memory*, 213, 107956.

DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.nlm.2024.107956>

Leon, C. S., Bonilla, M., Brusco, L. I., Forcato, C., & **Benítez, F. U.** (2023). Fake news and false memory formation in the psychology debate. *IBRO Neuroscience Reports*, 15, 24-30.

DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ibneur.2023.06.002>

León CS, Bonilla M, **Benítez FAU**, Brusco LI, Wang, J & Forcato C (2022). Impairment of aversive episodic memories during Covid-19 pandemic: The impact of emotional context on memory processes. *Neurobiology of learning and memory*, 187, 107575.

DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.nlm.2021.107575>

Urreta Benítez FA, León CS, Bonilla M, Flores-Kanter PE & Forcato C (2021). Identification Performance During Quarantine by COVID-19 Pandemic: Influence of Emotional Variables and Sleep Quality. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 4734.

DOI: <https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2021.691583>

Tassone LM, **Urreta Benítez FA**, Rochon D, Martínez P, Bonilla M, León CS, Muchnik C, Solis P, Medel N, Kochen S, Brusco LI, Moyano MD, Forcato C. (2020) Memory reconsolidation as a tool to endure encoding deficits in elderly. *PloS one*, 15(8), e0237361.

DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0237361>

PREPRINTS

Bonilla M. Vidal V, Vazquez Chenlo A., León CS, **Urreta Benitez FA**, Brusco L, Flores-Kanter E, Bauza C & Forcato C. DIFFERENTIAL EFFECTS OF THE COVID-19 PANDEMIC SITUATION BETWEEN YOUNG AND OLDER ADULTS OVER RECALL AND RECOGNITION. *SSRN preprints*.

DOI: <https://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.4206859>

Benitez, F. U., Leon, C. S., Bonilla, M., Garrido, M., & Forcato, C. (2024). PSYCHOLOGY OF MEMORY APPLIED TO A REAL CASE OF WRONGFUL CONVICTION.

DOI: <https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/aq35x>

SCIENCE AND JUSTICE LINK (PART OF THE COLLABORATION WITH INNOCENCE PROJECT ARGENTINA)

- **Dra. Cecilia Forcato, Lic. Candela León, Lic. Facundo Urreta Benítez, Lic. Matías Bonilla.**
Participation in 2 Amicus Curiae together with Innocence Project Argentina.
- **Dra. Cecilia Forcato, Lic. Candela León, Lic. Facundo Urreta Benítez, Lic. Matías Bonilla.**
Professional Practice Innocence Project Argentina. Neuroscience and Justice Workshop. Instituto Tecnológico de Buenos Aires (ITBA). 2021,2022, 2023,2024,2025
- **Urreta Benitez, F & Lic. Bonilla M.** Neuroscience and Justice. Formation of False Memories and errors in identification lineups. Innocence Project Argentina, Virtual Workshop. August 2023.

WORKS PUBLISHED IN CONFERENCES AND WORKSHOPS

2024

Facundo Urreta Benítez^{1,2,3}, Candela S. Leon^{1,2}, Matías Bonilla^{1,2}, Cristian Bauza⁴ & Cecilia Forcato¹. (2024) Effects of Misinformation on Witness Memory. I Jornada de Tecnología y Salud (ITBA), Buenos Aires, April 2024.

2023

Bonilla M, **Urreta Benitez FA**, León CS, Scheinsohn C, Jimenez ZA, Escrofani C, Adba J, García-Bauza C & Forcato C. (2023) Role of a previous nap on facial recognitions. Preliminary results. Neuroscience and Philosophy Meeting (ITBA), Buenos Aires, November 2023

Urreta Benitez FA, Bonilla M, León CS, García-Bauza C & Forcato C (2023) Misinformation and Consolidation Processes in the Performance of Eyewitnesses. Preliminary Results. Neuroscience and philosophy meeting 2023. Buenos Aires, November 2023.

León CS, Lo Celso AL, Olivar N, Toledo J, **Urreta Benítez FA**, Bonilla M, Brusco LI & Forcato C (2023) GABAergic modulation in the formation of declarative and recognition memories. Neuroscience and philosophy meeting 2023. Buenos Aires, November 2023.

Urreta Benitez FA, Bonilla M, León CS, García-Bauza C & Forcato C (2023) Misinformation and Consolidation Processes in the Performance of Eyewitnesses. Preliminary Results. Congreso de la Sociedad Argentina de Neurociencias 2023. San Luis, October 2023.

León CS, Lo Celso AL, Olivar N, Toledo J, **Urreta Benítez FA**, Bonilla M, Brusco LI & Forcato C (2023) GABAergic modulation in the formation of declarative and recognition memories Congreso de la Sociedad Argentina de Neurociencias 2023. San Luis, October 2023.

Bonilla M, **Urreta Benitez FA**, León CS, Scheinsohn C, Jimenez ZA, Escrofani C, Adba J, García-Bauza C & Forcato C. (2023) Role of a previous nap on facial recognitions. Preliminary results. Congreso de la Sociedad Argentina de Neurociencias 2023. San Luis, October 2023.

2022

León CS, Lo Celso AL, Olivar N, Toledo J, **Urreta Benítez FA**, Bonilla M, Brusco LI & Forcato C. GABAERGIC MODULATION IN THE FORMATION OF DECLARATIVE AND RECOGNITION MEMORIES: PRELIMINARY RESULTS. Congreso de la Sociedad Argentina de Neurociencias 2022. Buenos Aires, October 2022.

Urreta Benitez FA, León CS, Bonilla & Forcato C. A CASE OF FALSE RECOGNITION IN THE ARGENTINE JUSTICE. Congreso de la Sociedad Argentina de Neurociencias 2022. Buenos Aires, October 2022.

Bonilla M. Vidal V, Vazquez Chenlo A., León CS, **Urreta Benitez FA**, Brusco L, Flores-Kanter E, Bauza C & Forcato C. Lockdown consequences on different age ranges on episodic memory. Congreso de la Sociedad Argentina de Neurociencias 2022. Buenos Aires, October 2022.

2021

León C, Bonilla M, Brusco LI, Forcato C, **Urreta Benítez**. SYNAPTIC HOMEOSTASIS AND FAKE NEWS. Congreso de la Sociedad Argentina de Neurociencias 2021. online, October 2021.

León C, Bonilla M, **Urreta Benítez**, Brusco LI, Wang Jingyi & Forcato C. Impairment of aversive episodic memories during Covid-19 pandemic: The impact of emotional context on memory processes. Congreso de la Sociedad Argentina de Neurociencias 2021. online, October 2021.

Bonilla M. Vidal V, León CS, **Urreta Benitez FA**, & Forcato C. THE IMPACT OF TIME, AGE AND FREQUENCY OF USE ON RECOGNIZING PERSONAL ITEMS OF OUR CLOSEST ONES: FORENSIC

IMPLICATIONS. PRELIMINARY RESULTS. Congreso de la Sociedad Argentina de Neurociencias 2021. online, October 2021.

Urreta Benitez FA, León CS, Bonilla M, Flores-Kanter E & Forcato C. Performance in Lineups during the Covid-19 pandemic. Influence of lock-down side effects. Congreso de la Sociedad Argentina de Neurociencias 2021. online, October 2021.

León C, Bonilla M, **Urreta Benítez**, Brusco LI, Wang Jingyi & Forcato C. FORMACIÓN DE MEMORIAS EPISÓDICAS AVERSIVAS DURANTE LA PANDEMIA POR COVID-19. Simposio Latinoamericano "COVID 19 y Cerebro", Universidad Autónoma de Honduras.

2020

Bonilla M, León CS, **Urreta Benitez FA**, Lippmann Mazzaglia T, Calvo C, Garrido M & Forcato C. False memory formation during Covid-19 quarantine: age, sleep quality and emotional variables. Preliminary results. Congreso de la Sociedad Argentina de Neurociencias 2020. online, October 2020.

León C, Bonilla M, **Urreta Benítez** & Forcato C. Emotional episodic memory formation during Covid-19 quarantine: Preliminary results. Congreso de la Sociedad Argentina de Neurociencias 2020. online, October 2020.

GRANTS

- **Grant from the National Agency for Scientific and Technological Promotion, Working Team, PICT- 2020-SERIEA-02666.** Consolidated Group. Construction of False Memories in Witnesses of a Criminal Event: the role of Consolidation, Reactivation and Sleep Stages. 2022-2025.
 - **Grant from the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme (ITEC): “Modern Techniques of Psychological Investigation Methods Polygraph, Narco, BEOS, SDS, LVA.”**
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SUPERVISION OF UNDERGRADUATE THESES

- **Sebastián Soria Oroza.** (2023). Avances en el uso terapéutico de la reconsolidación de la memoria. [Undergraduate Thesis]. Faculty of Psychology, University of Buenos Aires. Buenos Aires, Argentina.
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SCIENTIFIC TALKS GIVEN

- **Urreta Benítez, F.** (2025, September). Fake news, false memories and ideological alignment in Argentine psychology [Roundtable presentation]. In C. Forcato (Presidency), Advances in the field of sleep and memory neuroscience [Mesa redonda]. 27° Congreso Argentino de Neuropsiquiatría y Neurociencia Cognitiva, Salón Goya, Argentina.
 - **Urreta FA, León CS, Bonilla M & Forcato C.** Mesa redonda sobre Falsas memorias y su impacto en el sistema legal. XXV Congreso Argentino de Neuropsiquiatría y Neurociencia Cognitiva, Buenos Aires, August 2023.
 - **Lic. Urreta Benítez Facundo.** Fake news, falsas memorias y alineación ideológica en la psicología argentina. XXIV Congreso Argentino de Neuropsiquiatría y Neurociencia Cognitiva, Buenos Aires, September 2022. <https://congresoana.org/>
 - **Urreta FA, León CS, Bonilla M, Brusco LI, Wang, J & Forcato C.** "Formación de memorias episódicas aversivas durante la pandemia por COVID-19". Simposio Latinoamericano "COVID 19 y Cerebro". Latbrain, Universidad Autónoma de Honduras. Honduras. November 2021
 - **Urreta FA, León CS, Bonilla M, Brusco L, Wang J & Forcato C.** "Impairment of aversive episodic memories during COVID-19 pandemic: The impact of emotional context on memory processes". XXXVI Annual Meeting of The Argentine Society for Research in Neuroscience. Argentina. October 2021.
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FELLOWSHIPS OBTAINED

- **2021,** Beca para realizar el Curso IBRO-LARC Neuroscience and AI for all Virtual Associate School, INTERNATIONAL BRAIN RESEARCH ORGANIZATION (IBRO)

- **2020, Beca interna doctoral CONICET.**
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MEMBERSHIP OF ORGANIZATIONS

- **2021 - present. Sociedad Argentina de Investigación en Neurociencias**
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ATTENDANCE AT SCIENTIFIC EVENTS

2023

- **XXV congreso argentino de neuropsiquiatría y neurociencia cognitiva, congreso, Argentina**
- **I jornada de profesionales argentinos en ciencias del comportamiento, jornada, Argentina**
- **Workshop neuroscience & philosophy meeting, workshop, Argentina**
- **San 2023 meeting, congreso, Argentina**

2022

- **XXIV congreso argentino de neuropsiquiatría y neurociencia cognitiva, congreso, Argentina**
- **Día internacional de la condena errada, jornada, Argentina**
- **Congreso anual san 2022, congreso, Argentina**

2021

- **Semana de divulgación científica: hacia una psicología basada en evidencia, jornada, Argentina**
- **Jornada por la psicología científica, jornada, argentina**
- **Ciclo de webinars de red inocente. vol. i: la fabricación de culpables, seminario, México**
- **Simposio latinoamericano "avances recientes sobre la neurobiología del ciclo vigilia-sueño"**
- **Congreso anual san2021, congreso, Argentina**

2020

- VIII congreso de innocence project latinoamérica 2020, congreso, México
- San2020 XXXV annual meeting, congreso, argentina
- Construyendo puentes entre la filosofía y la neurociencia, seminario, Argentina

2019

- XXXIV reunión anual san 2019, congreso, argentina
- VII congreso de innocence project latinoamerica 2019, congreso, argentina

PRESS / INTERVIEWS / RADIO / TELEVISION

- Lic. Facundo Urreta Benítez. Guilty or Innocent? A Journey into Recall and Facial Recognition. Argentine Society for Neuroscience Research.
<https://saneurociencias.org.ar/culpable-o-inocente-un-viaje-a-la-evocacion-y-al-reconocimiento-facial/>
 - Lic. León C.S., Lic. Urreta Benítez F.A., Lic. Bonilla M. Radio interview given to *Revista de Derecho Penal y Criminología* (Thomson Reuters – La Ley). July 2023
 - Bonilla Matías, Herrero Nerea, León Candela, and Urreta Benítez Facundo: Radio segment on Vorterix Salta, in the program "Alternas". <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4BJsAKpxxfw>
 - Interview for the book: Esteban, P. (2025). *Innocents* (in collaboration with Innocence Project Argentina). El Gato y La Caja. <https://elgatoylajaja.com/libros/inocentes/hacer-memoria>
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